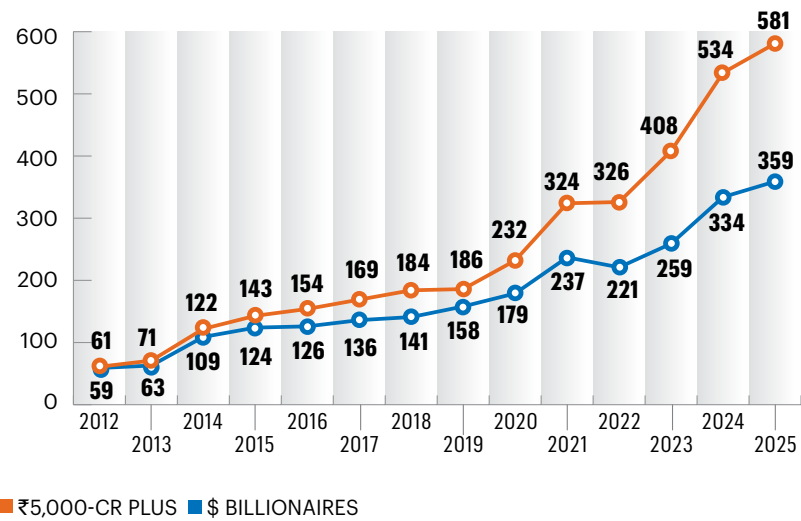


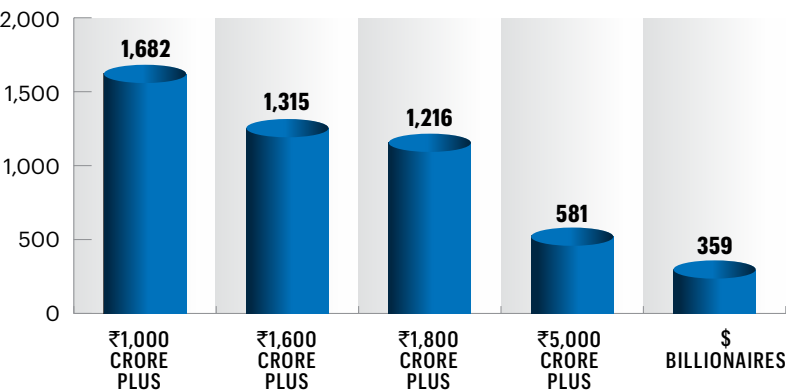
THE BILLIONAIRE PIPELINE

• The number of people with ₹5,000 cr wealth is up 10 times since 2012



MINTING FORTUNE

• India’s super-rich class is growing larger, younger, and more diverse



SOURCE HURUN RESEARCH INSTITUTE, M3M HURUN INDIA RICH LIST 2025

route to the top: with patient, concentrated public-market investing, he has built his fortune backing fundamentally strong businesses across industrials, chemicals, and infrastructure, including Gujarat Fluorochemi-

cals, Sudarshan Chemical, and One97 Communications. He has proven that disciplined, long-term value investing can still create billionaire-scale wealth in India, without founding a company at all.

The Hurun Rich List data from 2012 to 2025 reveals just how dramatically this acceleration is playing out at the very top of India’s wealth pyramid, specifically among individuals worth ₹5,000 crore or more. This cohort has grown nearly tenfold: from 61 in 2012 to 581 in 2025. What stands out isn’t just the scale, but the pace of compounding. It took nine years, from 2012 to 2021, for the group to grow from 61 to 324 members, roughly 5.3 times growth. But it took just four more years, from 2021 to 2025, for that number to nearly double again to 581. That’s a clear signal that ultra-high-net-worth wealth creation in India is accelerating structurally.

In comparison, the count of dollar billionaires rose from 59 in 2012 to 359 in 2025, a significant growth, but slower in absolute terms than the ₹5,000 crore-plus cohort. The gap underscores that India’s super-rich class is growing larger, younger, and more diverse in sector and geography.

What makes this moment particularly significant is the pipeline just behind it. A large and growing set of profitable tech and consumer unicorns are preparing for public listings. IPOs have become the primary mechanism for converting paper net worth into realised billionaire status.

Zepto’s founders are simply the most visible example of a much larger cohort waiting for their moment on the exchange. When that wave of listings plays out over the next few years, India’s official billionaire count and its median age could look very different from what it does today. **BT**

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